

ROHINTON MISTRY

A Fine Balance

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Why, he wondered he kept working now... Why did he not jump off the top of one of them? Why did he not make a bonfire of the receipts and the cash, and throw himself onto it drenched in kerosene? How was it his heart kept beating instead of bursting, his sanity intact instead of shattering like a dropped mirror? Was it all made of tough synthetic material, like the indestructible plastic folder? And was time, the great vandal being neglectful ?

"God is dead" said Maneck. "That's what a German philosopher wrote".... "And do you Believe it?" (asks Dina) "I used to. But now I prefer to think that God is a giant quilt maker. With infinite variety of designs. And the quilt is grown so big and confusing the pattern is impossible to see, the squares and diamonds and triangles don't fit well together anymore, it's all become meaningless. So he has abandoned it."

— Maneck
